

Chapter

Every Human Being Is Inherently Spiritual



Introduction: The Illusion of Two Worlds

Many people see life as split into two parts — on one side the "worldly" world of home, job, business and relationships, on the other the "spiritual" world of worship, meditation and temple. Acharya Upendra Ji calls this very division an illusion:

"Spiritual and worldly — they seem like two separate worlds. Have you met such people or not, to whom these seem like two separate worlds?"

And his answer for such people is clear:

"You will have to tell them that **there is no two world, there is only one world — that is a spiritual world, or adhyatmik.**"

In this chapter Acharya Ji shows that every action of ours — marriage, business, profession — is in fact spiritual, and also that even the most misguided person is, without knowing it, seeking the Self alone.

A 200 Percent Life: Not a Division, an Overlap

One of Acharya Ji's well-known maxims is to live life fully, completely on both sides:

"If you live, live a **200 percent life** — 100 percent spiritual, 100 percent worldly."

But this maxim is often misunderstood, as if the day were to be split into two equal halves:

"So people think it means 12 hours in the office, 12 hours in the temple. It is not like that."

Acharya Ji clarifies that both run at a full hundred percent together — **one on top of the other**:

"That 100 percent and 100 percent — they are an **overlap**, one on top of the other."

That is, the world and spirituality are not two separate blocks of time. Whatever work we do in the world carries a layer of spirituality over it.

Seeing God in Marriage and Business

Acharya Ji explains this overlap through two examples from life. The first is marriage:

"You want to get married — if that seems like the world to you, it is 100 percent spiritual for you — overlap. **The Devi has come; it is the pair of Shiva and Parvati.**"

Seeing one's life partner as the Devi and married life as the pair of Shiva and Parvati — this is what makes marriage spiritual:

"So whatever I have to do, all of it is **Lord in the form of** — spirituality will be over it all twenty-four hours."

The second example is business:

"You have to do business — **customer is God**; he has come bringing Lakshmi, he is Vishnu. Yes, so how will I have to do it? **Shri Vidya applied.**"

The customer is Vishnu himself, who has come bringing Lakshmi with him. Business done in this spirit is itself the practical application of **Shri Vidya**. (**Shri Vidya** — the tradition of worship of Devi Lalita Tripurasundari, which Acharya Ji teaches in connection with prosperity and everyday life.)

The conclusion is:

"So twenty-four hours — are you understanding or not? **24 by 7 it is only my spirituality.**"

Dutiful Action Is Itself Dharma

Acharya Ji takes this point deeper — every duty is itself dharma:

"Actually, when I perform some duty or other, **the very meaning of dutiful action is dharma.**"

"So when I am a medical doctor and I am treating someone, I am doing dharma itself. If I loot, I am doing **adharma.**"

That is, the line between dharma and adharma is drawn not by the profession but by the conduct. The same doctor is doing dharma when he heals and adharma when he loots. And all this goes on whether or not the person realises it:

"He may be aware or unaware. Are you understanding or not?"

Even the Lustful Man Desires Only the Self

Here Acharya Ji says something startling. Even the one we would consider most astray — a person drowned in lust — is unknowingly seeking the Self:

"A lustful person — even an extremely lustful one, gripped by sexual desire — when he desires some woman, **he is not aware, he too is desiring that same principle of the Self.** He doesn't like just that body."

Whether that woman is his girlfriend, or he goes somewhere else — his attraction appears to be towards the body, but in reality it is towards something else:

"Even the lustful man, **out of ignorance, loves the Self, not the body.** Because if tomorrow that woman is gone, will he be able to love the dead body? He is unaware."

"He does not know whom he is loving. That power which can make this woman dance, which can dance... **it is actually that power alone that he desires.**"

Atma-tattva, the principle of the Self — that conscious presence which keeps the body alive, beautiful and active. The attraction is to that; the body is only its vehicle.

A Straight Test: Can One Love a Dead Body?

To test this truth, Acharya Ji gives a direct touchstone:

"His test is simple, straightforward: **if that power has gone, will he love the dead body?** Answer this question. He will not be able to."

And this applies not only to the lustful man but to the closest relationship too:

"Even the wife will not be able to love the husband. So says **Shankaracharya Ji in Bhaja Govindam.**"

This verse of Adi Shankaracharya's **Bhaja Govindam** states this very truth:

yāvat pavano nivasati dehe tāvat prcchati
kuśalaṃ gehe |
gatavati vāyau dehāpāye bhāryā bibhyati tasmin
kāye ||

"As long as the life-breath dwells in the body, the people at home ask after one's welfare; once the breath has left and the body has fallen, even the wife fears that very body."

— Bhaja Govindam 6

Contemplating Flesh and Bone

So that the point sinks in deeply, Acharya Ji paints a harsh but powerful picture:

"So I always keep saying: **bring that woman's flesh and bone and place it in front of you, then show me your love.** Her bone is given into your hand — show me your love."

"Her excreta is filled in a box and brought to you — go on, love this. Her blood is filled in seven or eight bottles and given to you — go on, was that her or not?"

"Her bones are all pinned up into a skeleton and hung under the ceiling fan, and as the air blows it starts swaying like this — imagine it — **and now love her. Will he be able to?**"

The image is deliberately shocking, so that the listener pauses for a moment to reflect:

"That moment is needed, which is why I made you visualise it."

Bone, flesh, blood — even with all the components of the body before you, love does not arise. This proves that the object of love was never the body at all.

Love and Hatred: The Play of Ignorance

Then whom does a person love? Acharya Ji answers, citing Shankaracharya Ji:

"He loves — Shankaracharya Ji says — the living one, that power, that Self."

The ignorance lies only in this: he ties this love to the fulfilment of his own wishes:

"It is only this much — out of ignorance, if things went according to his wish, he calls it love; if they did not, he calls it hatred. He doesn't understand."

What we call love and what we call hatred — both are our reactions to that one Self, depending on whether our wish was fulfilled or not.

Even the Lowest Person Is Spiritual

Acharya Ji gives the conclusion of this entire idea in these words:

"So even the lowest person keeps listening only to the Self, the inner Self."

"That is called — **he keeps unknowingly living the spiritual life itself**. Are you understanding this much or not?"

No human being is outside spirituality. The only difference is awareness — one walks towards the Self knowingly, another unknowingly.

Summary: Key Teachings

- 1 There is only one world.** Spiritual and worldly are not two separate worlds — there is only one world, that is a spiritual world.
- 2 A 200 percent life means overlap.** 100 percent spiritual and 100 percent worldly — not 12 hours in the office and 12 in the temple, but a layer of spirituality over every action.
- 3 God is in every relationship and every dealing.** Shiva and Parvati in one's life partner, Vishnu bringing Lakshmi in the customer — this is Shri Vidya applied.

- 4 **Dutiful action is itself dharma.** A doctor healing is dharma, looting is adharma — whether the person is aware or unaware.
- 5 **Attraction is to the Self, not the body.** Even the lustful man, out of ignorance, desires that same power, that same principle of the Self; once the life-breath leaves, no one can love the dead body.
- 6 **Love and hatred are two names of ignorance.** If the wish is fulfilled it is love, if not it is hatred — but the object is the same one Self.
- 7 **Every human being is inherently spiritual.** Even the lowest person listens only to the inner Self and is unknowingly living the spiritual life itself.